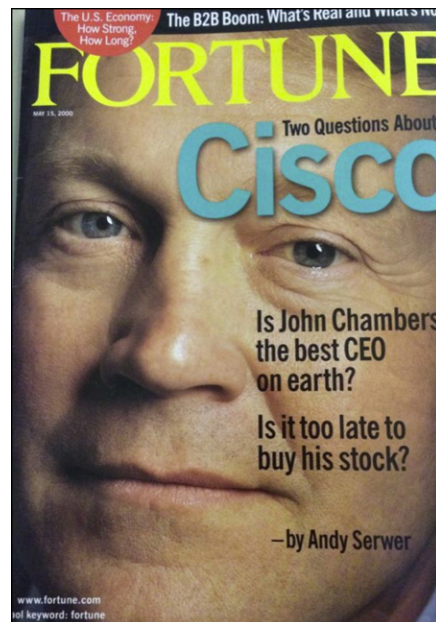


“No matter how you cut it, you’ve got to own Cisco.”

“THE FUTURE IS inherently unknown and unknowable.” That is a core philosophical belief I hold dear. The world is filled with endless and often-invisible random events. These unknowns have a huge impact on what comes next, derailing even the most thoughtful predictions.



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Which leads me to our first delightful cover story:

“No matter how you cut it, you’ve got to own Cisco.”

On May 15, 2000, *Fortune* published a laudatory cover story about the networking gear maker Cisco Systems and its brilliant CEO, John Chambers.⁸⁸ The cover poses these questions about Cisco:

1. “Is John Chambers the best CEO on earth?”
2. “Is it too late to buy his stock?”